

Win Back: when do inactive customers buy again?

Analysis of the repurchase cycle and of the Win Back + Churn
Risk broadcasts

FLOW AND BROADCASTS

Per email sent, the flow converts twice as much

Winback flow

October 2024 - September 2026

0.58% €0.39

conversion rate · revenue per recipient
9,007 emails delivered, 52 conversions

Win Back + Churn Risk broadcasts

10 sends: Feb 2025, Sep-Oct 2025, Sep 2026

0.29% €0.19

conversion rate · revenue per recipient
50,006 emails delivered, 146 conversions

Broadcasts bring more orders in total because they reach about 5,000 people per send. The flow only writes to customers who have just become inactive.

D2C apparel store · Win Back analysis · 2 · Klaviyo data, WooCommerce Placed Order metric, account's default attribution. CR per delivered email, not per person: since Oct 2025 the flow contains 9 different emails.

THE OBSERVATION

An inactive audience that converts better than expected

Conversion rate · revenue per recipient

Active customers

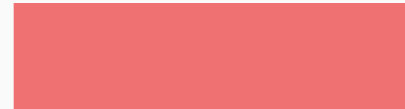
purchase in the last 210 days



0.80% · €0.52

Win Back + Churn Risk

no purchase for 210+ days



0.29% · €0.19

Non-buying subscribers

engaged, never purchased



0.05% · €0.03

Win Back converts almost 6 times more than non-buying subscribers, and about a third as much as active customers.

D2C apparel store · Win Back analysis · 3 · Broadcasts only, Sep-Oct 2025: same content sent in the same week to the three audiences (8 sends Win Back + Churn Risk, 8 non-buying subscribers, 6 active customers). CR = unique conversions / delivered emails, Klaviyo attribution.

Three possible explanations

1

Timing and occasion

The flow starts at a random moment. The broadcast arrives with a concrete reason to buy.

2

Reminder effect

The flow has already moved the customer towards a purchase. The broadcast closes it.

3

Longer repurchase cycle

Many customers naturally buy again after more than 210 days. The flow arrives before the need.

The analysis focuses on hypothesis 3 and, in part, on hypothesis 2.

What we analysed

23,641

completed orders

10,734

unique customers, identified by
anonymised email

12,907

repurchases measured (customers with
at least 2 orders)

Period	September 2021 to September 2026, completed orders only
Broadcasts	10 Win Back + Churn Risk sends: Feb 2025, Sep-Oct 2025, Sep 2026
Attribution	Coupon purchases only, within 5 days of the broadcast send
Customers	Inactive for at least 247 days: 210 to enter Win Back + 37 of flow

RESULT 1

The repurchase cycle varies widely from customer to customer

121 days

Half of repurchases happen within about 4 months

283 days

3 in 4 repurchases happen within about 9 months

343 days

4 in 5 within about 11 months. The remaining 20% come later

The flow threshold, **210 days**, falls in a "dead zone": it is neither the moment when most customers buy again (earlier, around 121 days) nor the moment when the slow tail wakes up (later, around 280-340 days). It catches neither the "regular" nor the "slow" customers well.

A single threshold does not describe all customers well.

Base: 12,907 repurchases by customers with at least 2 orders. A customer with many orders counts several times.

RESULT 2

Those who come back after a broadcast had been inactive much longer

549

total orders in the 5 days after the 10 broadcasts analysed



51

orders from customers inactive for at least 247 days, with an email coupon

505 days

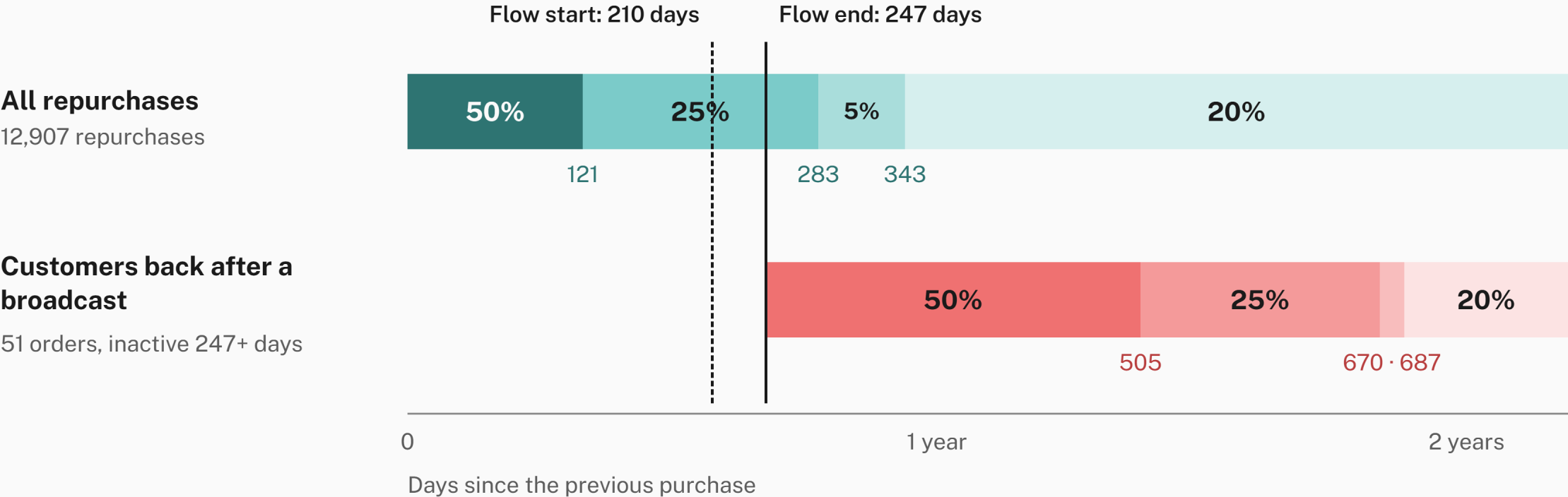
Half of the repurchases from customers inactive for 247+ days happen after about 16 and a half months

121 days

Half of all repurchases happen after about 4 months

RESULT 2

The two distributions compared



D2C apparel store · Win Back analysis · 8 · Bars capped at 800 days. The second row starts at 247 days because of the filter.

1 order in 4

comes from customers inactive for at least 670 days, almost 2 years.

The Win Back flow stops writing to them after 247 days, about 8 months. Even long-inactive customers can come back and buy.

CONCLUSIONS

What the data says, and what it does not say yet

✓ Supported by the data

- The repurchase cycle is highly variable: a single 210-day threshold does not describe all customers.
- Customers inactive for 1.5-2 years come back and buy after a discount email.
- After the flow ends, some customers still buy with an email coupon.

⚠ Not proven yet

- That the flow arrives too early.
- When customers are most likely to buy again.
- That the purchase is caused by the broadcast rather than by seasonality or other channels.

LIMITATIONS

Why these numbers should be read with caution

Small sample

Only 51 orders.

No rate by inactivity band

We know how many people received the broadcasts in total, but not how many in each band of days since the last purchase.

So we cannot say which band converts best.

Same coupon for flow and broadcasts

In 2025 the same code was used for both, so they cannot be told apart with certainty.

No control group

9 of the 10 broadcasts were sent in September-October: some purchases might have happened anyway, because of seasonality or other channels.

RECOMMENDATIONS

A multi-step, measurable Win Back flow

The analysis is a clue, not proof: the new flow also serves to verify it.



Where possible, content tied to an occasion: change of season, wardrobe refresh.

After step 2-3, send only to inactive customers who opened or clicked in the last 6-12 months, to avoid hurting deliverability.

RECOMMENDATIONS

How to make the test reliable

One code per step

Unique Klaviyo coupons with a prefix per source (WB07-, WB10-, ... and BC- for broadcasts): the code used in the order shows which email generated the purchase.

A control group

A random 10% of Win Back customers does not receive the flow. It is the only way to know how many would buy again anyway, without emails.

Protect deliverability

After the first 2-3 steps, send only to those who opened or clicked in the last 6-12 months.

Measure per recipient

For each step: % of customers who buy again and revenue per recipient net of discount, versus the control group. Fixed 5-day attribution window.

NEXT STEPS

Timing and reading the results

Now

Set up the flow steps, the source codes, the control group and the deliverability filter.



After 6 months

First read on the steps with enough data: repurchase % and revenue per recipient versus the control group.



Then

Keep the steps that convert better than the control group and drop the others.

Goal: know when it pays to contact inactive customers, based on measured data.